

Spring FLING

The recently concluded Delhi Fashion Week and the Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week were just a little two much

■ By Supriya Dravid

It was India shuffling, not shining, this festive season. Held simultaneously, the Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week (WIFW) and the Delhi Fashion Week (DFW) had spin doctors, stylists, shoppers and socialistas scurrying incessantly from one show to the next at vastly distant venues in the capital. While DFW was held at the DLF Emporio deep in south Delhi's Vasant Kunj, WIFW was routed to Pragati Maidan.

Fashion fatigue was endemic. Blame it on Sumeet Nair. The scorned former Fashion Design Council of India (FDCI) frontman, who claimed his "hands were tied there", rebelled by setting up the Fashion Foundation of India (FFI) earlier this year, roped in design dons Rohit Bal and Tarun Tahiliani and orchestrated the DFW to run parallel to the FDCI-organised WIFW. "Ours is a non-profit organisation that aims to promote Indian fashion," he declares. Fair enough. But how did he get the runway rolling without any sponsors? No one will tell.

While another fashion week may benefit both designers and service suppliers (like hair and make-up artists, models, choreographers and publicists), why did

The Spring Summer '09 line up saw a liberal use of **EARTHY** whites, creams, greys and ecrus. But it was smartly balanced by bursts of **SINGLE BLOCKS** of vibrant colours as seen in the collections of GAURAV GUPTA, NAMRATA JOSHIPURA (left) and LECOANET-HEMANT.



The frockfest saw **STRUCTURED** summer shifts from RAJESH PRATAP SINGH (right) and CUE. NITIN BAL CHAUHAN'S dresses had a strong dose of his trademark military-style influence. Debutant designers PANKAJ & NIDHI AHUJA sent out short, sharp dresses with subtle metallic mosaic-like surface embellishments.



REUBEN SINGH

